widening gap between the language of the Sanskrit drama and the languages of day-to-day life. By 1000 **A**. **C**. the popular spoken languages, out of which our modern languages have grown, were beginning to take literary forms.

Yet, in spite of all this, it is astonishing how the Sanskrit drama continued to be produced right through the medieval period and up to recent times. In 1892 appeared a Sanskrit adaptation of Shakespeare's 'Midsummer Night's Dream.' Manuscripts of old plays are continually being discovered. A list of these prepared by Professor Sylvain Levi in 1890 contained 377 plays by 189 authors. A more recent list contains 650 plays.

T h e language of the old plays (of Kalidasa and others) is mixed—Sanskrit and one or more *Prakrits,* that is, popular variations of Sanskrit. In the same play educated people speak in Sanskrit and ordinary uneducated folk, usually women, though there are exceptions, in Prakrit. T h e poetical and lyrical passages, which abound, are in Sanskrit. This mixture probably brought the plays nearer to the average audience- It was a compromise between the literary language and the demands of a popular art.